DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT REPORT

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Year : 2025
Couse Code : CSE0001

Date : 29th March, 2026

INTRODUCTION

This project focuses on digital literacy and cyber safety, describing how everyday internet usage can expose individuals to online risks. It showcases important concepts such as responsible digital behavior, safe internet practices, and awareness of cybercrimes. A key part of this project is a case study on UPI payment fraud, which demonstrates how scammers use simple manipulation techniques to deceive people and gain access to their money or personal information.
The project also includes practical components like creating awareness through an infographic, developing a social media checklist, and building a digital portfolio. These activities aim to improve understanding of how digital tools should be used safely and responsibly. Overall, the project emphasizes the importance of being alert, informed, and cautious while interacting online in today's increasingly digital world.

TASK 1

I created the awareness poster using Canva since it allows to create content by providing a variety of templates, fonts, colour themes , graphics and digital tools.My poster describes the what digital literacy is, how a person could maintain a professional online presence and how you must follow safe internet practices. I have create minimalistic but visually appealing poster that contains information that is easy to understand. I have used eye catchy colour themes, bold fonts , text boxes in different shapes and visually appealing graphics. I have also included short phrases to make the content interesting.
I found it challenging to categorise the content into different sections and align them in such a way that it looked minimalistic and informative at the same time. It was difficult to discuss 3 topics in a single poster. I learn to balance all the elements of the poster without crowding them and keeping it simple. This project has helped me improve my designing skills.

TASK 2

For this task, I created and updated accounts on GitHub, LinkedIn and Kaggle. I updated by GitHub account and created new accounts on Kaggle and LinkedIn. My GitHub account contains my personal repository which has a profile README. GitHub also contains my other repositories that contain my projects.
GitHub is used to show projects that you have made and it can track your progress in programming. LinkedIn helps in building a professional online presence and connecting with peers. Kaggle allows users to build their skills in data science and machine learning . Hence, I shall use this platform to develop my analytical skills.

For the next 4 years of my life, I aim to maintain consistency by constantly working on projects on these platforms to improve my technical skills and to make connections with various people and experts.

GitHub shall provide a glance into my portfolio, LinkedIn will be used to maintain my professional identity and to make new connections and Kaggle will be used to practice and present my technical skills. These platforms have helped me understand the importance of maintaining and online presence to make sure that I get new opportunities in the near future.

TASK 3

I practiced problem solving questions on all three platforms – Code chef, Hacker rank and Hacker Earth. I solved basic problems in python such as input/output type questions and conditional statements, questions that give strong base to build logic.
These helped me improve my accuracy in coding. It also helps me in logic thinking. Apart from these 3 platforms, I also use leetcode to practice problems, especially in python. It provides me a step by step approach on how to solve these problems with speed and accuracy.

All these platforms have helped me improve my coding skills. These platforms provide an environment where I contest my code, receive feedback, and understand mistakes through test cases. Practicing such questions have helped me in strengthening my basics in problem solving and programming that is important in subjects like DSAs. Overall, the problems on these platforms gave me a practical exposure to real world coding challenges.
One important aspect I like about these platforms are how it instantly tells me if my code is correct or not. And if it is correct, it will mention how much time I had taken to solve it, how many other people have succeeded to solve that particular question

TASK 4

In this situation, an image of a female youtube content creator goes viral . It was initially a clip of hers, were she made a wide eyed expression that gets tuned into a meme.

It was done by one of her viewers who takes a screenshot of this expression from the clip she posted and shares that on social media. Later, it gets widely shared without context and people in parts of Karnataka start using this image as a poster on abandoned buildings and shops to ward off the evil eye, or as Indians believe it to be called as “Nazar”. it is used without her consent and this shows how someone can misuse a digital content and how it can has serious or unexpected consequences. The woman gets angry and sues the person who does this. This could have been solved if he had just ask her permission before sharing it on media. We should share content online responsibly and be aware of its consequences if misused.

TASK 5

While researching on UPI fraud payments, what surprised me the most was how a scammer could trick and convince and innocent person just by easily gaining his/her trust.

Here, in my own case study, the scammer does not use any kind of technology but he pretends to be a known person to gain her trust. So she feels safe to share such a sensitive information and approve payment request. This made me realise that scammers do not always use technologies to scam someone but also scam them by exploiting human vulnerabilities. From this situation I have learnt a lesson that we should not share any kind of personal / sensitive information like – bank details, OTPs, etc to anyone before verifying it twice and check if thew person is actually genuine or not. Also, I will always verify before accepting anyone's collector requests. I have realised that being informed and being always alert is the best way to stay safe.

CONCLUSION

This project helped me understand the importance of digital literacy and responsible online behavior in today's digital world. Through different tasks such as creating an infographic, solving coding problems, building a digital portfolio, and analyzing a UPI fraud case study, I learned how technology can be both useful and risky. One of the key takeaways for me is that most cybercrimes happen due to lack of awareness rather than technical complexity. I also realized the importance of verifying information, protecting personal data, and thinking before acting online. Overall, this project improved my understanding of digital safety and will help me use technology more responsibly in the future.

REFERENCES

- Google Forms (for quiz creation)
- Canva (for infographic design)
- GitHub (for portfolio and README)
- LinkedIn (for professional profile)
- HackerRank, HackerEarth, CodeChef (for coding practice)
- National Cyber Crime Portal – Online resources and general awareness about UPI fraud and cyber safety - https://cybercrime.gov.in